

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ J 10 4 2
♣ J 10 8 5

♠ K J 10

♥ A Q 7

♦ A 7 5

♣ A Q 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 7 6 4 2

♥ 10 9 8 3

♦ 9 8

♣ 9 6

♠ A Q 5

♥ K J 4

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ K 3 2

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by North

two suits will have to split 3-3, so they will immediately test one, then the other.

In fact there is another possibility for success - even if neither suit is 3-3 it may be that the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits. In this case that defender can be squeezed. BUT, you don't play the ♣s and ♦s first, you play the other two suits.

Win the first ♥, then play two more ♥s and all three ♠ winners. That will be 6 tricks played, and each defender will be down to 7 cards left in their hand. If one of them happened to start with 4 ♣s and 4 ♦s he will have to discard from one of the holdings and you will be able to win your fourth card in that suit.

Although neither minor suit splits 3-3 it happens that West holds the guard in both suits.

When you play your sixth Major suit winner West is squeezed and must discard from one of his 4-card holdings.

This is an Automatic Squeeze, which just means you don't have to do any preparatory work. All you have to do is play off all your non-threat winners before you play the squeezing suits.

Partner has 20 or 21 points, balanced, and you have 18. You've always wanted to do this haven't you?

The contract would be 7NT played by South.

North plays 7NT. East leads the ♥10 and West follows with the ♥2.

DO NOT HOLD UP.

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 12

There are two chances for your thirteenth winner, your fourth ♣ or dummy's fourth ♦.

Some players will assume that means one of those

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 2
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ A 10 4
♣ 10 6 5

♠ K 9 8 7 5 4

♥ 7 5 4

♦ 9 8 6

♣ Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6
♥ K 9 2
♦ K J 3
♣ J 8 7 3 2

♠ Q 3

♥ A 8 6

♦ Q 7 5 2

♣ A K 9 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
All Pass			
2♠ by South			
7			

Surely this hand will play better in ♠s than in notrump. So you transfer with 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

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You pass. In the old days, before transfers, you would have bid 2♠ with this hand as a sign-off. The only difference is that now partner gets to play it.

The contract would be 2♠ played by North.

South plays 2♠. West leads the ♥Q and East plays the ♥9.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total =

Suppose you win the ♥A, play over to the ♣Q, then try to get back to your hand with a trump to discard 2 losers on ♣ A K. If it worked that way it would be fine, but it is very likely that a defender would win their trump Ace, then take their 2 ♥s and 3 ♦s. You could be down one before you even got started.

A better approach is to trade one of your ♣ winners for a quick discard. Take the ♥A, then play ♣ A K, discarding a ♥ from dummy. That will eliminate one ♥ loser.

You probably cannot avoid your 3 ♦ losers, but you may be able to get out with losing a single trump. **IF** ♠s split 3-2, and **IF** you can win tricks with both the ♠K and ♠Q then you will make it. The only way it can happen is if East holds a doubleton ♠ A x. You must play the first ♠ from dummy, so ruff a ♣ to get there, then lead a small ♠, putting on your ♠Q when East follows low. This wins the trick, (hip-hip), so you now play your ♠3, ducking in dummy. When East has to take his ♠A, (hooray), you are home-free.

With East holding the ♠A, this Plan clearly works.

But, if you need East to hold the ♠ A x anyway, perhaps that first plan would have worked better. You know, take dummy's ♣Q, then play a low ♠ to get to your hand.

It depends on East. If he ducked the low ♠ then you could get **TWO** discards and make an overtrick.

The method given here gives up the possibility of an overtrick for an improved chance of making the contract. You choose.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6 2
♥ 3
♦ 9 8 4 2
♣ Q 10 6 3

♠ Q 10 9 4

♥ A Q 8 6

♦ A K

♣ A J 4



♠ 8

♥ 7 5 2

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ K 9 8 5 2

♠ A 7 5 3

♥ K J 10 9 4

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 7

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

North plays 6♥. East leads the ♠8. To play the ♠A or not to play the ♠A, that is the question.

Loser List: ♠ = 2? : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

At first thought it seems the ♠ lead has saved you a guess in the suit. By playing low in dummy you will force West to put on the King, (if he has it), winning the trick but leaving you with a pretty good position in ♠s.

That's why it's good to have second thoughts at the Bridge table. Think about the meaning of the ♠8 lead. If it is fourth down, then the Rule of 11 tells you that there will be 3 cards higher than the 8 spread among South, West, and North. **BUT YOU CAN SEE 4 HIGHER CARDS.** So your conclusion is that East has **NOT** made a fourth-down lead, but rather has led top-of-nothing, top-of-a-doubleton, or perhaps a singleton.

You don't know which of the above, but you do know that West holds both the ♠ K J. The danger is if the ♠8 is a singleton and you play low from dummy they could get a ♠ trick and a ♠ ruff. So don't play low from dummy. Win the ♠A at trick 1, pull trumps and then play ♠s from dummy toward your ♠ Q 10 9, giving West the ♠K but finessing him out of his known ♠J.

If West led the ♠8 from ♠ 8 6 2 then it wouldn't matter whether you played the ♠A or not, you would always make the contract.

If West led the ♠8 from ♠ 8 6 or ♠ 8 2 then it also wouldn't matter whether you played the ♠A or not, you would always make the contract.

If West led the singleton ♠8 then you had better play the ♠A or you will be down before you start.

It is unlikely that West would lead the ♠8 from any holding containing one or both of the honors.

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Feel free to use Blackwood. But if partner shows 3 Aces you only have enough points to bid 6, and if he shows 2 Aces you would still bid 6. So Blackwood will keep you out of slam if he has only 1 Ace. Or, you could just take a chance and bid 6♥.

The contract would be 6♥ played by South.

To rotate the hands and make North the declarer